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SUPERSEDING
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July 31, 1964

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PLASTER, PATCHING, GYPSUM, (SPACKLING)

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Standardization Division, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers spackling, paste and powder.

1.2 Classification. Spackling shall be of the following types and container sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

1.2.1 Types.

Type I - Powder.
Type II - Paste.

1.2.2 Sizes.

Powder - 5 pound boxes.
Powder - 25 pound bags.

Paste - 1 quart cans.
Paste - 1 gallon cans.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

L-P-378 - Plastic Sheet and Strip (Polyolefin).
RR-S-366 - Sieve, Test.
UU-S-48 - Sacks, Shipping, Paper.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-C-96 - Cans, Metal, 28 Gage and Lighter.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from the established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized and Containerized Unit Loads 40 Inch x 48 Inch Pallets, Skids, Runners, or Pallet-Type Base.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Classification Board:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies shall be adderssed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Attention: Tariff Order Station, 1616 P Street, N. W., Washington, D. C. 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, 202 Union Station, Chicago, Illinois 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Type I. Material shall be a fine white powder consisting of a uniform mixture of suitable fillers, binders and modifying agents.

3.1.2 Type II. Paste shall consist of pigments, binder and preservative as required to meet the requirements of this specification.

3.2 Type I, powder.

3.2.1 Fineness. A minimum of 95 percent of dry powder shall pass through a No. 100 mesh screen (see 4.4.2).

3.2.2 Mixing ratio. The powder shall readily mix with water. A ratio of 10 parts powder to 4 to 5 parts water by weight shall form a smooth paste of working consistency (see 4.4.5.2).

3.3 Type II, paste.

3.3.1 Weight loss. Paste shall not lose more than 40 percent by weight when tested in accordance with 4.4.3.

3.3.2 Density. The density shall be a minimum of 12 pounds per gallon (see 4.4.3).

3.3.3 Alkalinity. The pH value shall be between 8 and 9 when tested in accordance with 4.4.4.

3.4 Performance, types I and II.

3.4.1 Cohesiveness, type II. Spackling shall not be sticky or gummy when applied with a trowel or broad knife (see 4.4.5.2).

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3.4.2 Drying time (see 4.4.5.2.1).

3.4.2.1 Type I, powder. The mixed paste shall dry hard in not less than 2-1/2 nor more than 5 hours after the addition of water.

3.4.2.2 Type II, paste. The paste shall dry hard within 8 hours after application.

3.4.3 Chalking, types I and II. Spackling shall not chalk when tested in accordance with 4.4.5.2.2.

3.4.4 Contraction, types I and II. Spackling shall not sag when applied to deep narrow cracks and shall not pull away from edges of cracks (see 4.4.5.2.3).

3.5 Workmanship. Type I powder shall be smooth, uniform, and free of extraneous material. Type II paste shall be homogeneous, and free of caking, granulation, hardening, and putrid odor.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a lot shall consist of each type and size of spackling submitted for inspection at one time.

4.2.2 Visual examination of end item. Sampling for visual examination shall be in accordance with level S-3 in MIL-STD-105.

4.2.3 Samples for test. Samples for test shall be in accordance with level S-1 in MIL-STD-105.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 End item. Spackling selected in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The Acceptable Quality Levels (AQL's) for defects shall be 2.5 percent defective for major defects and 4.0 percent defective for minor defects.

TABLE I. Classification of defects, end item

Defects	Major	Minor
Type and size not as specified	X	
Powder not smooth and uniform	X	
Powder contains extraneous material	X	
Paste not homogeneous	X	
Paste caked, granulated, or hard	X	
Paste has putrid odor	X	
Damage or defects not affecting function or serviceability		X

4.3.2 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of contents the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery selected just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be II and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of container.

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4.4 Test methods.

4.4.1 AQL. The AQL for tests shall be 6.5 percent defective.

4.4.2 Fineness type I. Fineness shall be determined by screening 100 gm. of a dried sample (2 hours at 45°C.) through type I sieves in accordance with RR-S-366. Weigh the amount of the sample retained on the sieves (see 3.2.1).

4.4.3 Weight and density, type II. Determine weight and density using a scale accurate to plus or minus 0.1 pound (see 3.3.1 and 3.3.2). Determine weight loss by the difference between weight before and after maintaining a 1/2 pound sample at a temperature of 105° to 110°C for 3 hours in a well vented oven (see 3.3.1).

4.4.4 Alkalinity, type II. Determine the pH value by means of a suitable pH meter, properly calibrated (see 3.3.3).

4.4.5 Performance, types I and II.

4.4.5.1 Specimen. Prepare a specimen as follows:

(a) Gypsum board 1/2 inch thick, 4 inches wide and 8 inches long.
(b) On one side apply a brown and finish plaster coat. Press putty knife in the surface near one end of the specimen to simulate a dent. Dry specimen.
(c) On each 8 inch long edge, cut or saw slots across the edges at the mid points. Slots shall be of equal width 1/8 inch, plus or minus 0.05 inch. Depth of slots shall be approximately 1/4 inch.
(d) Score across back side of specimens between slots and fracture the specimen halves apart.
(e) Push the specimen halves together with shims 0.156 plus or minus 0.005 inch thick inserted in the slots. Clamp specimen on a table or bench to prevent movement.

4.4.5.2 Procedure. (ambient room conditions) Apply spackling to the crack and dent using a putty knife. Observe whether type I readily mixes with water, and after mixing observe whether it forms a smooth paste (see 3.2.2). Observe whether type II is sticky or gummy (see 3.4.1).

4.4.5.2.1 Hardness. Allow spackling to dry hard. Scratch spackling in dent with corner of putty knife. Observe whether spackling is difficult to scratch (see 3.4.2.1 and 3.4.2.2).

4.4.5.2.2 Chalking. Brush specimen clean. Rub hand or finger over filled dent and observe presence of chalking (see 3.4.3).

4.4.5.2.3 Contraction. Examine edges for separation of spackling from the crack. Use 2x magnification (see 3.4.4).

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Type I, powder. Five pounds of powder shall be put in a close-fitting kraft paper or polyethylene bag and packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, variety 2, style I, type A.

5.1.1.2 Type II, paste. One quart or 1 gallon quantities of paste shall be packaged in a round can conforming to PPP-C-96, type V, class 2.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Type I, powder. Five pounds of powder shall be put in a close-fitting kraft or polyethylene bag and packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566.

5.1.2.2 Type II, paste. One quart or 1 gallon quantities of paste shall be packaged in a round can conforming to PPP-C-96, type V, class 2.

5.1.3 Level C. The patching plaster shall be packaged to afford protection against damage during shipment from the supplier to the initial destination.

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5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Type I, powder.

5.2.1.1.1 Five pound quantity. Ten five pound packages of powder shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed, water-proofed and reinforced in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.1.1.2 Twenty-five pound quantity. Twenty-five pounds of powder shall be packed in a sack conforming to UU-S-48, type II, number 5 or 5x with a grade 1 moisture barrier on the inside of the innerwall, except the minimum total basis weight may be 150 pounds.

5.2.1.2 Type II, paste. The filled cans of paste shall be packed in accordance with the level A requirements of the appendix to PPP-C-96.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Type I, powder.

5.2.2.1.1 Five pound quantity. Ten five pound packages of powder shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domesitc. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2.1.2 Twenty-five pound quantity. Twenty-five pounds of powder shall be packed in a sack conforming to UU-S-48, type II, number 5 or 5X with a grade 1 moisture barrier, on the inside of the inner wall, except the minimum total basis weight may be 150 pounds.

5.2.2.2 Type II, paste. The filled cans of paste shall be packed in accordance with level B requirements of the appendix to PPP-C-96.

5.2.3 Level C. The patching plaster shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination at the lowest transportation rate for such material. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Palletization.

5.3.1 Level A. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the 25 pound sacks shall be palletized in accordance with MIL-STD-147, load type XV, bonding means K and L with storage aid 8. A cover secured to the pallet shall be provided in accordance with paragraph 5.1.3.3.1 of the standard, except the cover shall be fabricated from material conforming to L-P-378 with a minimum thickness of 0.002 inch.

5.3.2 Level B. When specified (see 6.2), the 25 pound sacks shall be palletized as specified in 5.3.1 except storage aid 8 is not required.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.

6.1.1 Type I. Powder spackling mixed with water is used for filling small cracks, scars or similar imperfections in interior plaster.

6.1.2 Type II. Paste spackling is used to fill hair cracks, scars and slight surface imperfections in plaster, tile or mosaics. It is also used for filling cracks, knotholes and nail holes in wood. Paste spackling can also be used to fill canvas and wall fabrics.

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6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type and container size (see 1.2).
(c) Size of lot, if different from 4.2.1.
(d) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) When palletization is not required (see 5.3.1).
(f) When palletization is required (see 5.3.2).

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

GSA DC 70-9571

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SPECIFICATION COMMENT SHEET

BUDGET BUREAU NO. 29-R0175

INSTRUCTIONS

This form provides a way for users of this specification to inform the originator of problems encountered in its use. It is not to be used to request changes to accommodate proprietary features. All comments will be considered and appreciated, but please do not expect a reply. To comment: detach, complete, fold, staple, and mail.

NOTE: Comments on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any part of the document or serve to amend contractual requirements.

1. SPECIFICATION

SS-P-00450(GSA-FSS) Plaster, Patching, Gypsum, (Spackling)

2. CONTRACT NO. *(If any)*	3. QUANTITY ON CONTRACT *(Optional)*	4. DOLLAR VALUE *(Optional)*

5. GENERAL NATURE OF PROBLEM *(e.g., inspection difficulties, manufacturers unable to meet tolerances, containers collapse under normal warehousing conditions, etc.)*

6. SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS AFFECTED *(Include paragraph number and lines of wording)*

7. SPECIFIC PROBLEMS *(e.g. tests in 4.2.2 will not assure that the battery will last required time; temperature ranges in table 2 do not conform to commercially available items.)*

8. RECOMMENDATIONS

9. NAME OF MANUFACTURER, ASSOCIATION, GOVT., AGENCY, ETC.	10. ADDRESS *(Number, Street, City, State and Zip Code)*

11. NAME AND TITLE OF SUBMITTER	12. DATE

FORM GSA FEB 89 2200

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